

PARISH OF BANAGHER

23rd Sunday in Ordinary Time – 6th September 2026

Mass Times Mass

Times:

Monday: St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9.30am
 Tuesday: St. Mary's Church, Altinure: 10.00am
 Wednesday: St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen: 7.00pm
 Thursday: St. Mary's Church, Altinure: 10.00am
 Friday: St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9.30am

Weekend Mass Times for Sunday 13th September 2026

St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 7.00pm Vigil
 St. Mary's Church, Altinure: 10.30am
 St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12.00pm Noon

Confessions

St. Mary's Church, Altinure: Thursday 10.30am
 St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: Friday 10.00am
 St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: Saturday 6.30pm

Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament and Divine Mercy Chaplet

St. Mary's Church, Altinure: Thursday 10.30am – 11.30am.
 St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: Friday 10.00am – 11.00am.

A Month's Mind Mass will be celebrated for Patsy Murphy, RIP, at St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn on Saturday 13th September at 7.00pm.



Banagher Parish Monthly Cash Prize Draw ~ Tickets on Sale!

✠ Money raised will go towards the ongoing refurbishment and ✠
 ✠ maintenance of our Churches ✠

Draws for 10 Cash Prizes will take place in **October, November and December**.
 30 chances to win! Tickets cost **£30** and are now on sale and available from our
 Church Sacristies and Parochial House and from Feeny Spar, Park Vivo,
 Mace Derrychrier and Sperrin View Bar. Thank you very much for your support.

September	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn		St Mary's Church, Altinure
	7.00pm	9.15am	10.30am
Readers	Natalie McCloskey	Mary Kathleen McDermott	Noeleen McGlinchey
Eucharistic Ministers	Bernie Lynch	Geraldine McCloskey	Andrena O'Kane
Flowers	Bridget Kealey		Briege McLaughlin
Cleaning	Margaret Cartin, Angela Hasson		Audrey McElhinney, Martina Moore
Counters	Ann Hassan, Marian & Anthony O'Neill, Patricia McCloskey		Philomena Conway, Sean Conway, Karen Feeney
Collectors	Dermot Lynch Vincent McCloskey	Anthony O'Neill Patrick McGrellis	Eamon Feeney, Patrick Conway

Blessing of Motorcycles next Sunday 13th September at St. Aengus' Church, Burt, Co. Donegal at 1.30pm. All are very welcome. All money raised will be donated to the RNLI Station at Ned's Point, Buncrana.

Prayer for Vocations: We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world.

Michael English Church Concert: An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2nd October at 7.15pm in St. Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available to buy at Herons Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena Post Office, and at the Ballinascreen and Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>.

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) is celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26th September in the Church of the Irish Martyrs, Letterkenny, Co. Donegal at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal McKeown and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our Mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

OFFERTORY COLLECTION

29th & 30th August 2026

St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: £870 St Mary's Church, Altinure: £585
 St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen: £500

Please consider online contributions and Gift Aid. Online Contributions to:

Parish of Banagher Sort Code: 950306 A/c 51052659

Thank you for your continued generosity.

Feast Days this Week

Tuesday 8th September: Nativity of Mary. We celebrate the Birth of Mary, who brought Jesus Christ the dawn of hope and salvation into the world. She is the Ark of the Covenant, the temple of God, because her body received the one Mediator.

Wednesday 9th September: St. Ciaran was born in Roscommon around 512. He came to Clonmacnoise in January 545 where he founded a monastery which was to become one of the most renowned in Europe. He died at the age of thirty-three while the monastery was still being built.

Thursday 10th September: St. Peter Claver was born in Verdu, Catalonia, in 1580 and studied at the University of Barcelona. He became a Jesuit; and while he was studying philosophy in Mallorca, the doorkeeper of the college, Alfonso Rodríguez, saw that his true vocation was to evangelize the New World, and encouraged him to fulfil that vocation. (Rodríguez was later canonized on the same day as Peter Claver himself). He arrived in Cartagena, in what is now the country of Colombia, in 1610, and after his ordination six years later he became a servant to the native people, labouring on their behalf for 33 years, attending to both their spiritual and material needs. The slave trade around at the time was repeatedly condemned by the Popes, but it was too profitable to be stopped and on the whole the local church hierarchy kept quiet about it, much as they did in North America in the 19th century. He brought fresh food to the slave-ships as they arrived, instructed the slaves and baptized them in the faith, followed their progress and kept track of them even when they were sent to the mines and plantations, defending them as best he could from oppressive slave-owners. At the end of his life he fell ill with a degenerative disease and for four years he was treated neglectfully and brutally by the servant whose task it was to look after him. He did not complain but accepted his sufferings as a penance for his sins.

JOB OPPORTUNITY

Derry Diocesan Trust: Sacristan

Hours of work: 12 hours per week. Place of work: St. John the Baptist Church, Granaghan (Swatragh) Parish. Rate of Pay: £12.88 per hour. For application packs, please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or telephone 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St. Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than **12 noon on Tuesday 15th September 2026**.

Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

Privacy Notice - The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A privacy notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting the Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn, St. Mary's Church, Altinure and St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen are available online. Please note that the first three rows of seats are visible online in St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn and St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen, and the first six rows of seats in St. Mary's Church, Altinure.

COMMUNITY NEWS

Dungiven and Feeny local committee for Cancer Research UK would like to thank everyone who supported and helped in any way with our 'Dungiven Walk of Hope 2026'. The walk raised the amazing sum of £8,780.01! Thank you everyone for your continued support.

Learmount Community Development Group (PARK): Week commencing **Monday 7th September:** Dementia Social Group: (11 am - 1 pm); **Tuesday 8th:** Men's Hobby Workshop (10.30 am - 12.30 pm); Advice NW (2 - 4 pm); Funky Feet Kids dance class (5 - 6 pm); Slow Sewing (7 - 9 pm); **Thursday 10th:** Post Office Outreach Service (9 am - 12 pm); Painting for Pleasure (10.30 am - 12.30 pm); Park 60+ Club (12 - 2 pm); **Friday 11th:** Learmount Walking Group (10.30 am).

Dates for your diary: The following classes will resume on Monday 14th September: Ladies & Men's Yoga Classes in Park Hall; Time for Me Ladies (10.30 - 12.30 pm), Evening Art Class (7.30 - 9.30 pm). Saturday 19th September: Family Fun afternoon in Park with In Your Space Circus. Tai Chi sessions: Wednesday 23rd September. Booking is essential for classes: Tel 028 7778 1881 / WhatsApp 077 5111 8656 / DM / email: admin@learmountgroup.org

Glenshane House, Dungiven: A Free 4-week Family History Programme starts on Tuesday 22nd September from 6.30-9.30 pm. Topics - Local Roots; American Roots; Life in Ireland and the American Journey. It will also show how to research genealogical records. To book, tel. 028 7774 2494.

Host for Hospice: October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake! To request your FREE host pack or for more information, please call Ailbhe McDaid, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice, on 028 7135 9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com.

The Parish Webcams are now available to view on the Firestick. If you search for the iTech Media App and download it to your Firestick, you can then search for the Church.

PARISH CLERGY

Fr. Dermot McGirr, P.P.

42 Glenedra Road, Feeny, BT47 4TW

Tel: 028 7778 1223 Email: banagherparish@derrydiocese.org

CONTACT US

To arrange a Baptism, Wedding or Anniversary Mass, please call Fr. Dermot or the secretaries on 028 7778 1223 or email banagherparish@derrydiocese.org.

Parish Office opening hours next week: Monday to Friday: 9.30am - 12.30pm.

Mass is Live on the Webcam at www.banagherparish.com
SVP Confidential Helpline: 075 9395 4973